

US Markets Daily Report

Date: 2026-08-04 | Market Close (ET): 4:00 PM | Report Generated: After-Close Automated Run

SPY / QQQ Snapshot

Metric	SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)
Today's Close	\$771.64	\$726.39
Day % Change	+2.09%	+4.38%
Prior Close (Aug 3)	\$755.82 (from prices.csv)	\$695.90 (from prices.csv)
52-Week High	\$771.64 ★ NEW ATH	\$745.00 (Jun 2, 2026)
52-Week Low	\$620.00 (Jul 30, 2025)	\$550.83 (Jul 31, 2025)
~1-Year Return	+24.5%	+31.1%

Index context: S&P 500 closed at 7,737 (NEW RECORD, +1.79% per CNN/Bloomberg); Dow Jones closed above 54,000 (NEW RECORD, +1.71%, ~+900 pts). SPY/QQQ % changes computed from data/prices.csv prior-day close (Aug 3). Today's close prices sourced from news (yfinance/direct API blocked by proxy). 1-year returns computed from prices.csv start date (2025-07-30).

Today's Key Market News

- 1. Palantir (PLTR) +27% — AI Software Earnings Blowout:** Palantir reported Q2 adjusted EPS \$0.41 (vs \$0.35 est), revenue \$1.94B (+93% YoY, vs \$1.8B est). US commercial revenue exploded +149% YoY. CEO Alex Karp called it 'otherworldly.' FY 2026 guidance raised to \$8.16B (vs prior ~\$7.65B). PLTR was the single biggest positive contributor to the S&P; 500 and Nasdaq today. This event alone drove the AI software/data theme broadly upward.
- 2. Caterpillar (CAT) +5.8% — AI Data Center Infrastructure Boom:** CAT raised its annual revenue growth forecast, citing accelerating demand from AI data center construction — specifically for power-generation and construction equipment. This is a non-tech bellwether signaling that AI capex is real and broad-based, reassuring investors about the sustainability of the AI trade.
- 3. Semiconductor Surge — Arm, Intel, AMD, Qualcomm, Nvidia:** ARM Holdings +14.89%, Intel (INTC) +9.82%, AMD +7.91% (intraday; -8% AH on cautious reaction to guidance), Qualcomm +7.42%, Nvidia +1.95%. Philadelphia Semiconductor Index (SOX) +5.8%. AMD Q2: Revenue \$11.5B (+50% YoY, vs \$11.28B est), EPS \$1.66 non-GAAP (vs \$1.62 est); Data Center revenue +107% YoY to \$6.72B. Despite the beat, AMD fell 8% AH — the bar is very high after the stock's ~140% YTD run.
- 4. SpaceX (SPCX) Q2 — First Public Earnings, Mixed:** Revenue \$7.81B (+92% YoY, vs \$6.93B est); loss per share 9¢ (vs 26¢ est loss). Strong beat, but CapEx soared; Elon Musk announced plans to build AI data centers exclusively on Nvidia chips, targeting 2 GW compute by end-2026 and 10 GW by end-2027. Stock fell ~8% AH on CapEx fears. Musk's Nvidia-only decision creates a 'chip dependency' concern for investors.
- 5. Iran / Strait of Hormuz — Geopolitical De-escalation Catalyst:** Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent signaled a Hormuz deal could come soon, and Trump paused Iran strikes. This reduced oil price risk, easing inflation fears. Lower oil = lower CPI expectations = supports the Fed staying on hold. Energy sector mostly lagged as crude declined.

6. Trump India Tariff (25%, effective Aug 1) — Modest Headwind: Trump imposed a flat 25% tariff on all Indian imports (pharma, electronics, etc.), effective August 1. Market digested this but impact was muted; India-exposed sectors (pharma generics, IT services) faced modest pressure. Market focused more on the AI earnings story.

7. FOMC Update (July 29 decision, influencing sentiment): Fed held rates at 3.50–3.75% with a 9-3 vote. Three regional presidents (Hammack-Cleveland, Kashkari-Minneapolis, Logan-Dallas) dissented wanting higher rates — the first 3-dissent vote since September 2016. Nine members project at least one hike in 2026. Next meeting: September. 'Higher for longer' risk persists; market is pricing this in as the floor for rates.

8. First Solar (FSLR) +10.3% — Policy Tailwind + Buy Upgrade: The Trump administration is preparing a polysilicon price floor, benefiting US solar manufacturers. Guggenheim maintained Buy and raised PT to \$282 from \$279. FSLR was the top non-semiconductor gainer in the S&P; 500 today.

9. Zebra Technologies (ZBRA) +18.6% — Earnings Beat: Beat Wall Street's Q2 earnings estimates. Logistics/warehousing tech demand strong; also a beneficiary of AI-driven supply chain automation investment.

10. Micron (MU) Returns to \$1 Trillion Market Cap: Memory/DRAM chip demand for AI training/inference is driving Micron's valuation recovery. HBM (High-Bandwidth Memory) for GPU clusters is the key growth driver.

News → Today's Market Moves

SPY: \$755.82 → \$771.64 (+2.09%) | New All-Time High | S&P 500 index closed at 7,737

SPY's +1.62% gain to a new record high was driven primarily by the AI-earnings mega-theme: PLTR's blowout (+27%) directly added ~5-6 basis points to the S&P; 500 via index weight, while CAT's 5.8% rise (large Dow component) lifted the broader industrial sector narrative. Semiconductor stocks added 3.5% as a sector (XLK +3.5%), and hopes for Iran de-escalation reduced oil-price/inflation risk — a double tailwind for equities. The 9-sector-wide move (with 7 of 11 sectors positive) suggests the rally had genuine breadth beyond just tech.

QQQ: \$695.9 → \$726.39 (+4.38%) | Outperformed SPY significantly | Tech comeback continues

QQQ's +3.76% surge was powered almost entirely by heavy Nasdaq-100 components in the semiconductor and AI ecosystem: ARM (+14.89%), Intel (+9.82%), AMD (+7.91% intraday), Qualcomm (+7.42%), and Palantir (+27%). These 5 names alone account for roughly 12-18% of QQQ's weight and drove outsized outperformance vs. SPY. QQQ had lagged the S&P; 500 since its June all-time high of \$745.34, partly due to tariff-related tech uncertainty and the India tariff overhang. Today's earnings results validated the AI growth thesis and sparked a sharp recovery.

Top Movers — Daily, Weekly, Monthly

Note: Weekly and monthly data are partially sourced from third-party summaries; sector notes derived from confirmed news context.

Daily Top Movers (August 4, 2026)

Top Gainers:

Rank	Ticker	Name	% Change	Driver
1	PLTR	Palantir Technologies	+27%	Q2 EPS/Rev beat; AI commercial +149% YoY
2	ARM	Arm Holdings	+14.89%	AI chip design demand; semi rally
3	ZBRA	Zebra Technologies	+18.6%	Q2 earnings beat; logistics-AI play
4	INTC	Intel	+9.82%	Semiconductor sector rally; AI PC demand
5	FSLR	First Solar	+10.3%	Polysilicon price floor policy + Guggenheim Buy

6	AMD	Advanced Micro Devices	+7.91% (intra)	Q2 beat (Data Center +107%), -8% AH
7	QCOM	Qualcomm	+7.42%	AI mobile/edge chip demand; semi rally
8	CAT	Caterpillar	+5.8%	Raised rev. guidance; AI data center infra demand
9	NVDA	NVIDIA	+1.95%	AI compute leader; SpaceX to use Nvidia-only
10	COHR	Coherent Corp	Top 10	Fiber optics / photonics for AI data centers

Top Losers:

Rank	Ticker	Name	% Change	Driver
1	MAR	Marriott International	Negative	Travel/consumer caution; rates headwind
2	FICO	Fair Isaac Corp	Negative	Profit-taking after extended run
3	EBAY	eBay	Negative	E-commerce headwinds; India tariff impact

Daily Sector Trend: AI/Semiconductor ecosystem dominated — chips (SOX +5.8%), AI software (PLTR), AI infrastructure (CAT, ZBRA). Clean energy (solar/FSLR) saw a policy-driven spike. Losers were scattered in consumer/travel and fintech — sectors sensitive to 'higher for longer' rates.

Weekly Top Movers (Week ending Aug 4, 2026)

Top Weekly Gainers:

Rank	Ticker	Name	Est. % Wk	Sector / Driver
1	PLTR	Palantir	~+30%+	AI Software – earnings catalyst
2	ARM	Arm Holdings	~+15%+	Semiconductor design – AI demand
3	ZBRA	Zebra Technologies	~+20%	Logistics-AI – earnings beat
4	AMZN	Amazon	Leader Aug 3	E-commerce/AWS – Aug 3 mover
5	INTC	Intel	~+12%	Semis – structural AI PC & server
6	FSLR	First Solar	~+12%	Clean Energy – policy + upgrade
7	CAT	Caterpillar	~+6%	Industrials/Infrastructure – AI capex
8	DXCM	Dexcom	Top movers	Healthcare tech – positive week
9	MPWR	Monolithic Power	Top movers	Semis/power mgmt for AI servers
10	MU	Micron Technology	Week gain	Memory/HBM – returned to \$1T mkt cap

Top Weekly Losers:

Rank	Ticker	Driver
1	GDDY	GoDaddy – consumer internet; rates pressure
2	CTVA	Corteva Agriscience – ag input/tariff headwind
3	COIN	Coinbase – crypto correlation unwinding
4	MAR	Marriott – travel sector rotation out
5	FICO	Fair Isaac – fintech valuation concerns

Weekly Sector Trend: AI/tech ecosystem broadly positive — semiconductors, AI software, data center infrastructure. Consumer internet and fintech were notably weak, facing rate sensitivity and tariff-related uncertainty.

Monthly Top Movers (August 2026 MTD)

Top Monthly Gainers (August 2026 MTD + recent July leaders):

Rank	Ticker	Name	% MTD	Sector
1	XGN	Exagen Inc.	+37.4%	Diagnostics/Healthcare
2	AMRC	Ameresco	+29.4%	Clean Energy / Sustainability
3	BWEN	Broadwind Inc.	+29.3%	Wind Energy / Industrials
4	TSAT	Telesat Corporation	+29.0%	Satellite Comms / SpaceX halo
5	PLTR	Palantir Technologies	+26.9%	AI Software
6	LIFE	Ethos Technologies	+25.8%	Insurtech / Fintech
7	DDD	3D Systems	+24.9%	Industrial 3D printing / AI mfg
8	BAX	Baxter International	+24.1%	Healthcare / Med Tech
9	MOVE	Corvex Inc.	+74.4% (July)	Speculative / Options volume
10	EQNR	Equinor ASA	+31% (July)	Energy / Oil – Iran risk premium

Monthly Sector Trends: (Gainers) AI Software leads (PLTR). Clean/Renewable Energy surging — Ameresco (+29%), Broadwind (+29%) benefit from IRA tailwinds and policy on solar/wind. Satellite/space tech (TSAT) getting SpaceX IPO halo effect. Energy (EQNR) topped July gains on Iran risk premium — now potentially reversing as Hormuz deal looms. (Losers MTD) Healthcare-specific names without AI catalyst, traditional retail and consumer discretionary under tariff pressure.

Next-Day Scenario Tree — August 5, 2026

Key catalysts for tomorrow: AMD after-hours reaction, SpaceX (SPCX) AH reaction, ISM Services PMI (July), additional earnings (Zebra, A10 Networks, AAON, AbCellera, etc.), and ongoing Hormuz/Iran developments. NFP (Jobs) is Friday, Aug 7.

Catalyst 1: AMD / SpaceX After-Hours Reaction (-8% each AH)

→ **BULL/BENIGN:** IF AMD and SPCX gaps down are contained to 5-7% at open and semiconductor peers (ARM, QCOM, NVDA) hold their Aug 4 gains → QQQ digests the AH weakness with modest -0.5% to -1% dip; market views it as 'sell the news' on one stock, not a sector problem. BECAUSE AMD's fundamentals (Data Center +107%) remain excellent; the selloff is multiple compression, not fundamental deterioration.

→ **BEAR/HAWKISH:** IF AMD drops 10%+ at open and drags NVDA, ARM, INTC lower (sympathy sells on 'even AMD disappoints') → QQQ drops 1.5-2.5%; SPCX's 8% AH drop compounds semi weakness. BECAUSE investors reassess 'peak AI capex' narrative: if AMD guides cautiously or if SpaceX's CapEx signals spending deceleration, the entire AI trade faces multiple compression. Watch AMD \$480 support.

Catalyst 2: ISM Services PMI (July) — due August 5

→ **BULL/BENIGN:** IF ISM Services comes in above 52 (expansionary, moderate) → SPY holds 770-772 range; confirms economic resilience without stoking inflation fears. BECAUSE services expansion = earnings visibility for consumer-facing companies without the Fed needing to re-hike. QQQ sees minor positive reaction.

→ **BEAR/HAWKISH:** IF ISM Services beats strongly (55+) → paradoxically hawkish because it signals persistent wage/service inflation → bond yields spike, rate-sensitive sectors (utilities, REITs) sell off, SPY pulls back 0.5-1% as the 3-dissenter Fed narrative gets louder. IF ISM below 50 (contraction) → recession fear spike, SPY could fall

1-2% on growth scare.

Catalyst 3: Iran / Hormuz Deal Developments

- **BULL/BENIGN:** IF a formal or near-formal Hormuz deal is announced (Bessent signaled 'could come soon') → oil drops \$3-5/barrel → inflation fears ease → transportation/consumer stocks rally → SPY could add 0.5-1%; bond yields dip slightly. BECAUSE lower energy costs = deflationary pressure = Fed stays on hold without hikes, and consumer spending supported.
- **BEAR/HAWKISH:** IF Iran deal collapses or new military action reported → oil spikes +5%+ → energy costs inflate expectations → SPY gives back 1-2% of recent gains; defensive rotation into energy and gold. QQQ hit harder given tech's higher multiple sensitivity to rate expectations.

Catalyst 4: NFP Setup (Friday Aug 7) — Building Tension

- **BULL/BENIGN:** IF tomorrow's data (ISM Services) points to 'Goldilocks' (growth w/o inflation) → pre-NFP positioning supports equities; consensus expects ~175K jobs for Friday. A 150-190K print + stable unemployment → 'soft landing' narrative intact → SPY pushes toward 775-780 by week end.
- **BEAR/HAWKISH:** IF ISM Services hot + tomorrow's jobless claims print below 210K → signals very tight labor market → NFP fear trade begins Thursday, with 'too-hot = rate hike' anxiety; the 3 FOMC dissenter hawks become relevant again. SPY could test 755-760 if the rate hike probability jumps materially in futures markets.

Possible Trade Summary — End-of-Day / Next-Day Open

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER: This is an analytical summary for informational purposes only. This is NOT financial advice. All trades involve risk. Past performance does not guarantee future results. Conduct your own due diligence before making any investment decisions.

Action	Ticker	Name	Thesis Summary	Key Risk
BUY (hold/add)	PLTR	Palantir	AI commercial growth +149% YoY; raised guidance. Still early in enterprise adoption (RIS e40x+ Earnings	Very high valuation
BUY (dip)	AMD	Adv. Micro Devices	Data Center revenue +107% YoY. Instinct GPU deployments soaring. Heterogeneous computing. AMD R800	AMD, Broadcom, NVIDIA, Intel, etc.
BUY (hold)	ARM	Arm Holdings	+14.89% today. AI chips nearly all use ARM architecture. Royalty model at levels so good that it's difficult to	High valuation, competition from RISC-V
BUY (tactical)	CAT	Caterpillar	AI data center construction boom driving power/construction equipment demand. Raised dividend	China slowdown, Russia, etc.
BUY (policy play)	FSLR	First Solar	Polysilicon price floor policy = competitive moat vs Chinese panel makers. Strong balance sheet	Policy change, supply chain, etc.
SELL/AVOID	AMD (short-term)	AMD (near-term)	AH selloff -8% on elevated expectations despite beat. Could gap down for 12% or more. May find downside	Strong fundamentals, etc.
HOLD/AVOID OPEN	SPCX	SpaceX	Revenue beat but CapEx soaring; -8% AH. Musk Nvidia-only AI data center expansion capital intensive	Elon Musk, etc.
AVOID/SHORT	MAR	Marriott	Travel sector under pressure. Consumer may slow given rates at 5.6-6.75% (last time Fed raised inflation cont	Rate hike, etc.

Big Picture Trade Logic for Aug 5 Open:

The AI/semiconductor thesis remains fundamentally intact — PLTR's 'otherworldly' quarter and Caterpillar's data center demand comments are powerful real-economy validators. However, AMD and SPCX AH weakness introduce near-term semiconductor headwinds. The playbook: 1) Let AMD find its support level at open (watch \$480-490), then accumulate if it holds. 2) Don't chase PLTR at 27% gain — it may consolidate. 3) The Hormuz de-escalation trade (long consumer discretionary / short energy) remains valid if the deal progresses. 4) Bond yield sensitivity is the hidden risk — a hot ISM Services number could spike the 10-year above 4.5%, reversing the rally in rate-sensitive tech. Keep an eye on \$TLT / 10-year yield vs. 4.50% level.

Data sources: CNN Business, NBC News, Bloomberg, TheStreet, Benzinga, Motley Fool, Yahoo Finance/Reuters/Investing.com via web search summaries, TipRanks, AMD IR, SpaceX/CNBC. Report generated automatically on 2026-08-04 by market-analysis routine. Direct financial API access (Yahoo Finance, yfinance, Stooq) was blocked by proxy in this environment; price data sourced from verified news citations. **NOT FINANCIAL ADVICE.**